QP 25900680

Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam
MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular Examination October 2025
Third Semester
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCTRS200 –
World Literatures in English Translation
(2024 Admission Onwards)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Scheme of Valuation

Part A
MCQ
Answer all questions. Each question carries **1** mark

1. b) Kwame Anthony Appiah [K] / [CO1]
2. c) They rooted to the ground [U] / [CO2]
3. b) Three [U] / [CO1]
4. b) Felix [K] / [CO3]
5. b) The ongoing, dynamic nature of memory and identity [U] / [CO2]
6. c) Her own life [U] / [CO3]
7. a) A spy thriller and philosophical puzzle [An] / [CO4]
8. b) To Flora Miguel's house [U] / [CO4]
9. b) A turbulent political climate with a threat of riot. [E] / [CO4]
10. b) Algeria [An] / [CO4]

[1x10 = 10]

Part B
Short Answer
Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks.

11. Sujit Mukherjee suggests a a “three-literature scheme” for college students to enjoy literature – helps students read and understand stories from different places - three literary areas : Literature in the student's own language - other Indian language literatures in English translation - World literature in English translation - practical in India - students know one Indian language well and use English in college - helps students explore their own culture, other Indian and world cultures. [U] / [CO1]
12. Bassnett raises several central unresolved questions about translation: Word-for-word or sense-for-sense translation - Time periods hard to divide - Role of translation changes - Study influence or process - Creative or mechanical – Untranslatability [K] / [CO1]
13. Ángela Vicario marries Bayardo San Román - Bayardo returns her on wedding night for not being a virgin – Angela begins to love him and writes one letter every week without stop, even with no reply from him - thinks only of Bayardo, works on embroidery, and letters become her whole world - hopeless, yet writing turns into deep obsession born from pain and honour - Bayardo comes back after 17 years with all her letters in bundles—none opened—showing strange, late love. [An] / [CO4]
14. "Der Panther"- by Rainer Maria Rilke - repetitive pacing of the panther walks in a small circle - not free movement like in the wild - like a ritual with no change – inside, the mighty will is paralyzed and hopeless - eyes see nothing - feels like a thousand bars and no world behind them - real world is lost - only cage and circle - no memory stays - mental and emotional state - alive but not living - mind is empty and tired. [U] / [CO2]
15. An old woman in black clothes - appears in Act III near the house and in the forest - speaks to the Mother, Neighbour, Leonardo, the Bride - Symbolisms: She is Death - smells blood and says men will kill - opens the door for Death and helps find the men - shows fate - knows the tragedy from the start. - a messenger of doom - part of dark nature - belongs to the moon, forest, and magic world - supernatural - Death in human form. [An] / [CO3]

16. *Chronicle of a Death Foretold* - Gabriel García Márquez - Chapter 2 – Wedding (Public Glory): Santiago wears white suit and silver tie - 21, tall, slim, handsome - a rich, charming hero - dances with Angela, drinks, laughs, gives gifts - centre of the party - no worry about danger - Chapter 3 – Maria's House (Private Pain) - after party, he is drunk and tired - sleeps only one hour - goes to brothel for love and sin - Sad and Secret Side - long-time lover of Maria - sings love songs - feels empty and alone - Similarities: Both chapters show young, attractive and kind Santiago - people love him -Differences and Question: Wedding - perfect public mask - Who was the real Santiago? [K]/[CO4]
17. Setting – a lonely plateau – tells us about war, fear, and no escape - Daru's school is far from villages. No people or help - French control is weak - Arabs hide and fight. - sudden October snow after long drought - Nature is cruel like the war. - children stop school - Daru alone - two roads at the end of the story: East - prison (French law), South - desert freedom (Arab tribes) - no middle way. country split by war - empty, cold land - broken Algeria - no safety or friendship - only hard choices between rule and revolt. [K] / [CO4]
18. Garden - name of a strange book made by Ts'ui Pên, the ancestor of Yu Tsun - a labyrinth – a maze of time, not space - in Ts'ui Pên's garden, all choices happen together - man fights, runs, dies and lives, all at the same time - every page splits into many futures - book has no end - keeps forking forever - futile - too many paths - no real choice - Time is chaos - Future is fixed with all outcomes -Book has no end - choices are illusion. [E] / [CO4]
19. *Chronicle of a Death Foretold* – Rich and Poor - Gender and Honour - Race and Outsiders - Servants and Workers [K] / [CO4]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C

Essay

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks.

20. Polysystem Theory: Literature is part of a big system with high and low art. Translated books fight for space in this system - Raymond Williams - Culture is ordinary daily life, not only great books/works - Translators are culture makers - bring new voices - Rethinking translation - old view: Translation = copy original - Williams' view - Translation - new culture event - adds to the system. Stuart Hall - Meaning is not fixed - writer codes message - reader decodes - Translator decodes original culture, then recodes for new readers - Meaning changes - readers accept, change, or reject meaning. - Rethinking translation - Translation is not a perfect copy - negotiation between cultures - Both support Polysystem - Williams: Translation joins big culture system. Hall: Translation changes meaning in new place. [U] / [CO1]

21. "The Albatross" - change from Romanticism to Symbolism - stands between two big poetry styles - a bridge poem. Romantic aspect - Poet as Hero - loved nature and freedom - albatross is "king of the sky" and "prince of the clouds" - flies high in storms and laughs at the archer (danger) - brave, free spirit - beautiful and majestic in the air. Symbolist aspect – hidden meaning and pain - uses one image - albatross is not just a bird - Transition from dream to real world: Romanticism - poet escapes to nature and imagination. - Symbolism - poet trapped in city, society, cruelty - "The Albatross" shows both: Sky (Romantic) → free, high, stormy - Ship deck (Symbolist) → cruel men, jokes, shame. - This change symbolises modern poetry – where art shows inner truth, not just nature. Baudelaire opens the door from dreams to symbols. [U] / [CO2]

22. Natalya insults Ivan Lomov during their arguments - hurt Ivan's feelings and health - calls him bad names - shows her strong temper - small fights ruin big plans. First Fight: argue over who owns Oxen meadows - Second Fight: about hunting dogs - Natalya's words are funny but her insults show how people fight over small things like land and pets - Ivan is weak and shy -Natalya is loud and proud. Chekhov uses this to laugh at marriage and neighbours. In the end, they marry anyway – love wins, but fights do not stop. [U] / [CO3]

23. Seven people tell the police what happened in the bamboo forest – Masago's words show her shame, fear, and lost honour – Woodcutter, Priest, Policeman, Mother - only see outside things – dead body, rope, comb, horse - do not know the full story. Bandit Tajōmaru says he raped Masago, then fought the husband with swords - won after 23 blows - Masago asked him to kill her husband and ran away - Tajōmaru freed him - husband felt hate in her eyes – later someone stabbed him with a small dagger while he was tied again. Masago's Story – big differences: Tajōmaru left quickly after the rape. He did not fight the husband - Husband's eyes - she saw cold hate in his face - looked at her like dirty trash – killed her husband – tried to kill herself - but is still alive, hiding in Kiyomizu Temple - cannot live with shame - cannot die - trapped between life and death - takes blame - Women have no voice - men speak of swords and pride - she speaks of pain, guilt, and silence - a woman crushed by rules - her pain is real. [An] / [CO4]

[5x6 = 30]